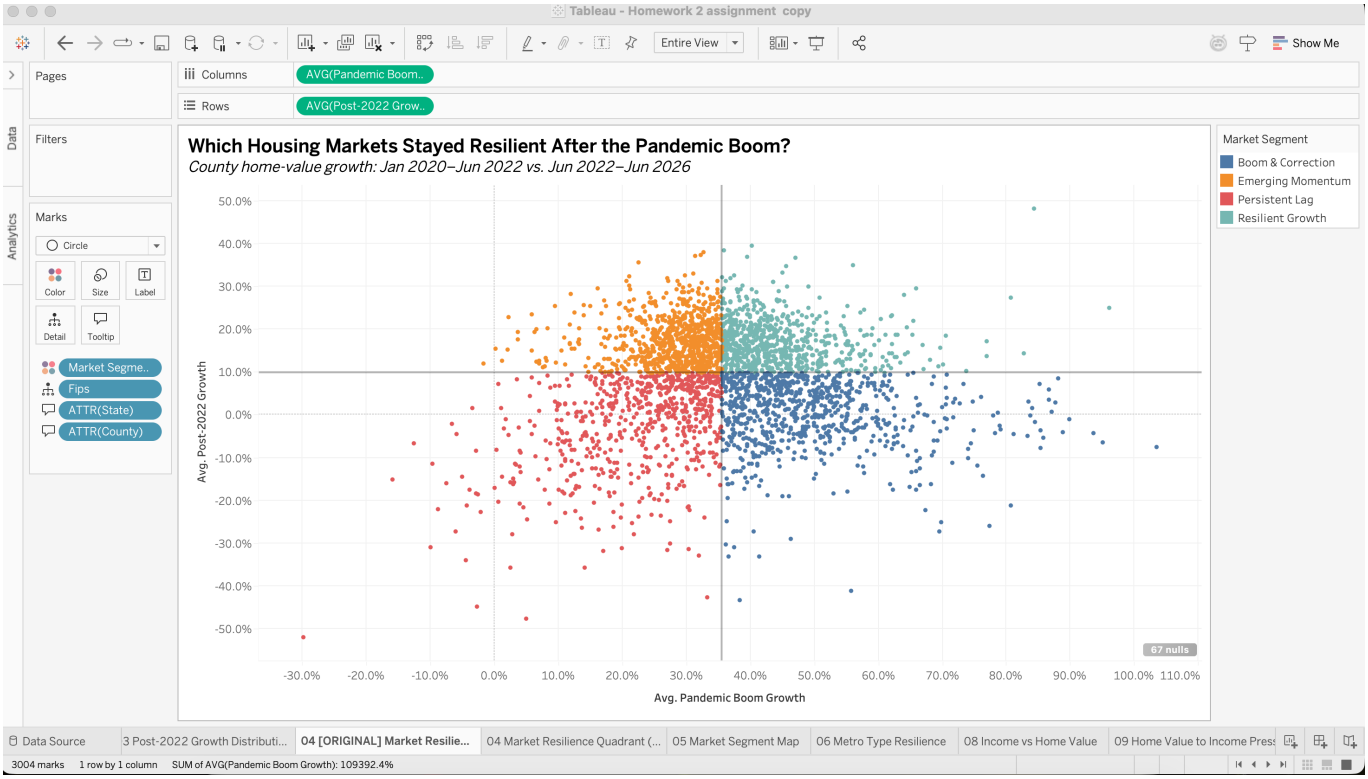
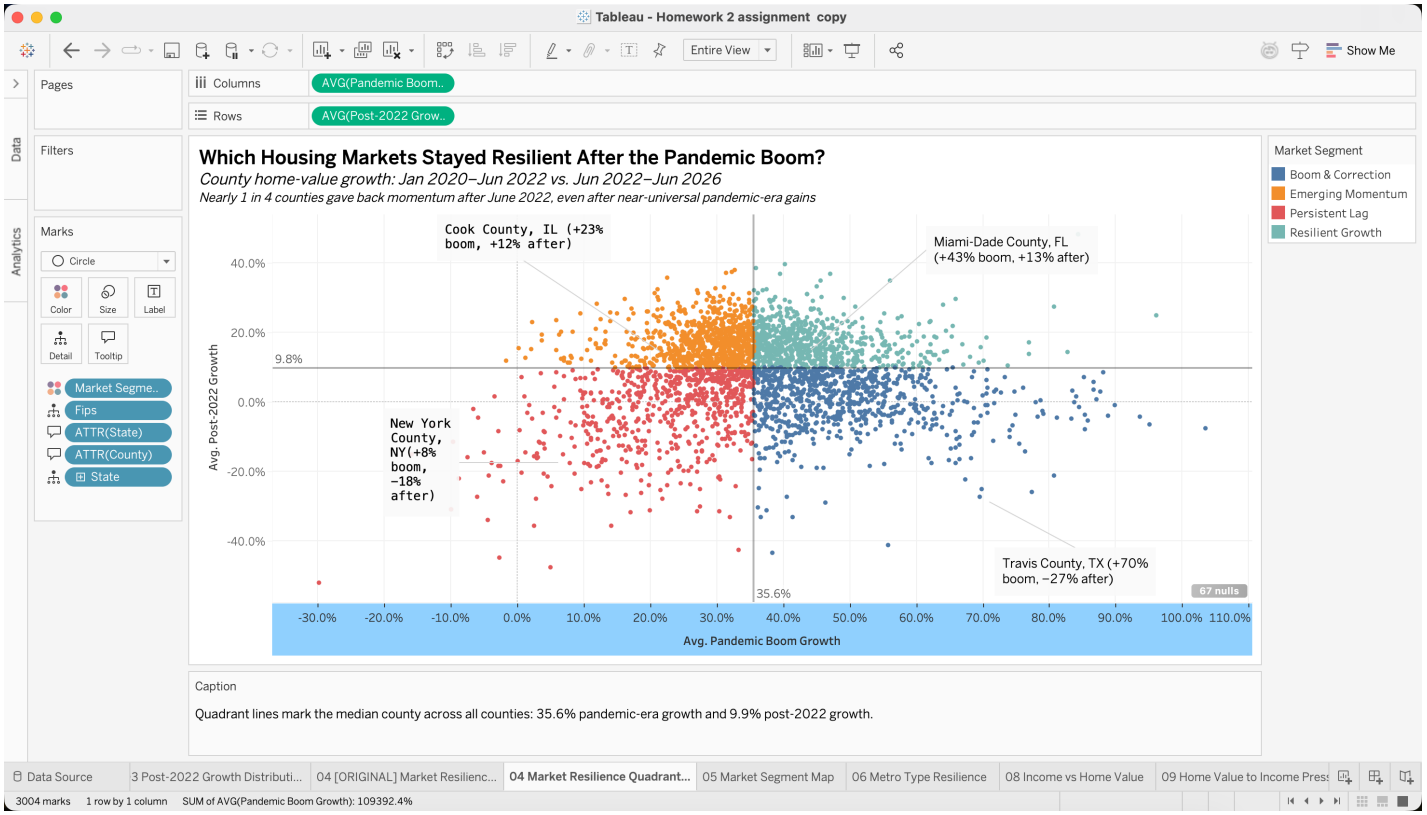
Homework Assignment 4

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Before: Original visualization from Homework 2 (“Which Housing Markets Stayed Resilient After the Pandemic Boom?”).



After: Revised visualization, incorporating peer feedback and the BUDT 705 Baseline Visualization Standards.



Revision Reflection

1. Problems and opportunities in the original

The original chart showed that market outcomes diverged after the pandemic boom, but left the viewer to infer the takeaway alone, a gap against Standard #5 (Communication), since a reader unfamiliar with my analysis would not know what to conclude. It also left the quadrant boundaries unexplained (Standard #1, Text and Labels): the gridlines had no visible values, so a viewer couldn't tell if they were medians, means, or arbitrary cutoffs. Finally, all 3,004 points were anonymous dots, with nothing tying the color categories back to real, recognizable housing markets.

2. What I changed, and why

I added a data-driven subtitle stating the key finding (“Nearly 1 in 4 counties gave back momentum after June 2022, even after near-universal pandemic-era gains”), calculated from the underlying county-level growth data. I labeled both reference lines with their actual values (35.6% and 9.8%) and added a caption clarifying they mark the median county across the dataset, making the quadrant logic transparent rather than implicit. I also annotated one recognizable county per quadrant , Miami-Dade FL (Resilient Growth), Travis County TX/Austin (Boom & Correction), Cook County IL/Chicago (Emerging Momentum), and New York County NY/Manhattan (Persistent Lag) , each labeled with its actual growth percentages.

3. How peer feedback shaped the revision

Chaitra Hegde's Assignment 3 review of this chart made three specific suggestions: add a takeaway subtitle naming the percent-change insight, explain how the four groups were defined, and label a few counties per quadrant so colors connect to recognizable markets. I incorporated all three directly, since each addressed a real gap against the Baseline Standards rather than a stylistic preference.

4. What's better about the revised visualization

A viewer can now grasp the finding in seconds: the subtitle states the headline statistic up front, the labeled reference lines make the quadrant logic auditable rather than assumed, and the four named counties let a reader map the color segments onto markets they already have intuitions about (Austin's dramatic correction, Manhattan's persistent softness). The chart now functions as a self-contained exhibit rather than one that depends on a presenter to narrate it.